The background colour makes gradient fills and fills in the erased areas of an image.

In the toolbox, you can see the current foreground and background colours. The foreground colour appears in the upper colour selection box and the background colour appears in the lower box. You can change the foreground and background colours, reverse the colours between the 2 levels and restore them.

From the colour picker, you can choose colours using four colour models: HSB, RGB, Lab, and CMYK and apply them to the foreground and background. Photoshop also gives you the ability to create your own colour swatches from natural pictures. Using the eyedropper tool you can sample colours from any part of the image. You can use colour from all layers in the document or only from the current layer.

Colour Space

Colour space refers to the 'format' of the colour as seen by the device. They are usually RGB (Red, Green, Blue), in case of camera, printer and monitor or CMYK (Cyan, Magenta, Yellow, Black) in case of commercial printing process. They all have unique and individual colour profiles and values. When shooting a JPEG photographs, most cameras save the image in sRGB colour space. This is then converted to Adobe RGB when the image is opened in Photoshop.

Pro tip- If you plan on uploading your images on the web, you should use the sRGB format and not the Adobe RGB colour space. This is because it is supported by virtually all digital cameras, ink-jet printer drivers, photo-editing software, Web browsers, etc.

That being said, any basic printer is capable of printing a wider range of colours than sRGB. So you may want to convert it to Adobe RGB or ProPoto RGB.

Bit-Depth

Bit depth is the information stored in the image. The primary information stored is the colour. The higher the bit depth of an image, the more colours it can store. The simplest image, a 1 bit image, can only show two colours, black and white. That is because the 1 bit can only store one of two values, O (white) and 1 (black). An 8 bit image can store 256 possible colours, while a 24 bit image can display over 16 million colours. As the bit depth increases, the file size of the image also increases because more colour information has to be stored for each pixel in the image.